

Tuesday, 22 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 16°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 15°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

19° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Seventeen people have been arrested in Teesside following large-scale organised crime raids across the area.**

The arrests are linked to the recent A66 crash, which tragically killed two police officers and five other men. Police say the raids are part of a major operation to tackle serious crime in the region.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **A new review suggests young people aren't 'snowflakes', but are genuinely experiencing a rise in mental distress.**

The head of the official review, Professor Peter Fonagy, says being young is significantly harder now than it was for previous generations. He highlights increasing pressures and challenges faced by today's youth.

HEALTH · UK

- 3 **Survivors of an Oxford grooming gang say they are still tormented by seeing their abusers in local supermarkets.**

The victims, who were underage girls at the time, say the men who sexually abused them are still walking freely around the city. This ongoing presence causes them significant distress and fear.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **Nigel Farage has unveiled Helen Jenner as the new leader of Reform in Wales, following the resignation of the previous leader.**

Farage stated it was 'untenable' for former leader Dan Thomas to continue in the role after his arrest last week. This move signals a new direction for the party in Wales.

POLITICS · UK

- 5 **Two people have been arrested in connection with a major fire at a hotel in Folkestone.**

A 38-year-old man and a 21-year-old woman were taken into custody on suspicion of arson. Emergency services were called to the scene after the blaze broke out at the hotel.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1

London Fashion Week has wrapped up, giving us a sneak peek at the top five trends for spring.

Designers showcased their latest collections, revealing the key looks we'll all be wanting for our wardrobes. Expect to see some exciting new styles hitting the high street soon.

ON AIR – Are you brave enough to try out the latest fashion trends, or do you stick to what you know?

FASHION · COMING UP

2

Fans are getting their first look at the much-anticipated 'The Other Bennet Sister' Christmas special.

Filming for the festive episode wrapped up back in October, and excitement is building for its return. It promises to be a highlight of the Christmas TV schedule.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Christmas TV special that you look forward to every year?

TV · COMING UP

3

Hollywood stars Ryan Reynolds and Rob McElhenney have bought the historic Turf pub in Wrexham.

The pub is a regular fixture in their Disney documentary series, 'Welcome to Wrexham'. It's a popular spot for fans and locals, right next to the football ground.

ON AIR – If you could own any iconic pub, which one would it be and why?

CELEBRITY · NOW

4

Strictly Come Dancing is back with a brand new hosting trio, as celebrities discover their dance partners.

Emma Willis, Josh Widdicombe, and Johannes Radebe have taken over presenting duties. The new series promises all the glitz, glamour, and ballroom magic we've come to expect.

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on the dancefloor this year, and do you have an early favourite?

TV · COMING UP

5

DJ Calvin Harris has been recognised for performing to a world record crowd of 1.6 million people.

The Scottish DJ's enormous set took place in Sao Paulo, Brazil, earlier this year. It's a huge achievement and highlights his global popularity.

ON AIR – What's the biggest crowd you've ever been part of, whether at a concert or a sporting event?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **There's a 'real fear' that darts sensation Luke Littler could walk away from the sport if the booing continues.**

Littler has reportedly suffered repeated booing at recent European tournaments. Many in the darts world are concerned about the impact this could have on the young star.

ON AIR – Do you think booing at sporting events has gone too far, or is it just part of the game?

DARTS · UK

2 **Kristi Montgomery has received her first call-up for Scotland's Nations League squad, as two key players drop out.**

The Blackburn Rovers midfielder joins the national team as Kieran Tierney and Kenny McLean are unavailable. It's a big opportunity for Montgomery to make her mark.

ON AIR – How important is it for national teams to bring in fresh talent and give new players a chance?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Scotland's Sandy Scott has earned promotion to the main PGA Tour after a career-threatening wrist injury.**

Scott won the Nationwide Children's Hospital Championship in Columbus, Ohio, to secure his spot. It's an incredible comeback story for the Scottish golfer.

ON AIR – What's the most impressive sporting comeback you've ever witnessed or heard about?

GOLF · UK

4 **Rangers have once again beaten rivals Celtic in the Scottish Premiership, thanks to a goal from Ryan Naderi.**

Naderi's first-half goal secured a deserved victory for Rangers in the highly anticipated Old Firm derby. The win will be a huge boost for the team and their fans.

ON AIR – What's your favourite local derby in any sport, and why does it mean so much?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Olivia Holdt scored a hat-trick as Tottenham thrashed 10-player Crystal Palace in the Women's Super League.**

Spurs scored seven goals in the second half, condemning Palace to their first defeat since being promoted. It was a dominant performance from Tottenham.

ON AIR – Are you following the Women's Super League this season, and which team are you backing?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists suggest that admiring a beautiful sunset can actually make you feel wealthier.**
Research indicates that moments of awe, like watching a colourful sky, can shift our focus from material wealth to time, making us feel more abundant in life's precious moments.
- 2 There's a growing trend for 'micro-adventures' – short, local escapades that don't break the bank.**
From wild swimming in a nearby lake to an overnight camp in the garden, these quick bursts of exploration offer all the benefits of adventure without the big travel plans.
- 3 A study reveals that people who regularly visit local markets tend to report higher levels of community connection.**
The bustling atmosphere and face-to-face interactions at markets foster a sense of belonging and support local traders, creating a lovely win-win.
- 4 The simple act of 'waving hello' to strangers is making a quiet comeback in some British villages.**
Often seen as a quaint, old-fashioned gesture, it's now being embraced as a small way to foster friendliness and neighbourly spirit, especially on morning walks.
- 5 New research suggests that the sound of a crackling fireplace can significantly reduce stress levels.**
The rhythmic, gentle sounds are thought to tap into ancient human instincts for comfort and safety, promoting a sense of calm and relaxation, even if it's just a recording.
- 6 The humble 'charity shop treasure hunt' is becoming a popular weekend activity for many.**
It's not just about finding a bargain; the thrill of discovering something unique and giving pre-loved items a new home is proving to be a delightful pastime for all ages.
- 7 Experts are encouraging us to rediscover the joy of 'writing postcards' when on holiday.**
In an age of instant digital messages, receiving a handwritten postcard through the letterbox is a charming surprise that brightens anyone's day and makes memories last longer.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 75% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television series, especially if it's a gripping drama. What is it?

ANSWER: MAKING SURE ALL THE CUSHIONS ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED AND ARRANGED JUST SO ON THE SOFA.

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE TOP OF THE LID, EVEN BEFORE OPENING IT, TO GET A 'PRE-TASTE' OF ITS FRUITY PROMISE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your bathroom or bedroom without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?**
Is it a trusty old towel, a particular brand of soap, or perhaps a favourite quirky mug for your morning brew? What's that one indispensable item in your home?

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't had one in years?**
Was it a classic Custard Cream, a digestive dunked in tea, or perhaps a Jammy Dodger? Which biscuit holds the key to your most nostalgic memories?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat, particularly brine shrimp and algae, which contain a pigment called canthaxanthin?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of mischievous otters is officially called a 'romp', and they often hold hands while sleeping so they don't drift apart?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest known snowflake, recorded in 1887 at Fort Keogh, Montana, was reported to be 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is said to be 'I am'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds; the water droplets and ice crystals are spread over such a large area that we don't feel the weight.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland, symbolising purity, innocence, and power.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Joseph Nicéphore Niépce, showing the view from his window.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.

On this day

Day 265 of the year, 100 days left in 2026. Today American Business Women's Day (United States); Baltic Unity Day (Lithuania, Latvia); Christian feast days: Digna and Emerita; Christian feast days: Emmeram of Regensburg. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1937 — Don Rutherford, English rugby player (died 2016)
- 1981 — Ashley Eckstein, American actress
- 1987 — Teyonah Parris, American actress
- 1930 — Joni James, American singer (died 2022)
- 1974 — Jenn Colella, American actress and singer
- 1982 — Billie Piper, English actress and singer
- 1933 — Leonardo Balada, Spanish-American composer and educator
- 1967 — Matt Besser, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — Red Dye No. 4 is banned by the US Food and Drug Administration after it is discovered that it causes tumors in the bladders of dogs.
- 2006 — Twenty-three people were killed in a maglev train collision in Lathen, Germany.
- 1979 — A bright flash, resembling the detonation of a nuclear weapon, is observed near the Prince Edward Islands. Its cause is never determined.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — The Dead Sea Scrolls are made available to the public for the first time.
- 1966 — Twenty-four people are killed when Ansett-ANA Flight 149 crashes in Winton, Queensland, Australia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1934 — The Gresford disaster in Wales kills 266 miners and rescuers.
- 1980 — Iraq invades Iran, sparking the nearly eight year Iran–Iraq War.

- 1965 — The Indo-Pakistani War of 1965 between India and Pakistan over Kashmir ends after the United Nations calls for a ceasefire and after a last engagement near Dograi.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 266 of the year, 99 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adomnán; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernardyna Maria Jabłońska; Christian feast day: Cissa of Crowland (or of Northumbria); Christian feast day: Blessed Elena Duglioli. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Bruce Springsteen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1945 — Paul Petersen, American actor, singer, author, and activist
- 1985 — Cush Jumbo, British actress
- 1958 — Danielle Dax, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1957 — Rosalind Chao, American actress
- 1978 — Anthony Mackie, American actor
- 1959 — Frank Cottrell-Boyce, English author and screenwriter
- 1947 — Mary Kay Place, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1932 — Saudi National Day: Crown Prince (later king) Faisal of Saudi Arabia, on behalf of Ibn Saud, proclaims the unification of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, the current iteration of the Third Saudi State.
- 1947 — A magnitude 6.9 earthquake strikes South Khorasan in Iran, killing over 500 people.
- 1962 — Flying Tiger Line Flight 923, a Lockheed L-1049H Super Constellation registered as N6923C, ditches into the Atlantic Ocean killing 28 out the 76 occupants onboard. The remaining 48 were rescued six hours later.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2022 — Voting begins in the five-day sham annexation referendums in Russian-occupied Ukraine, leading to Russian annexation of Donetsk, Kherson, Luhansk and Zaporizhzhia oblasts.
- 1955 — An all-white jury in Mississippi finds Roy Bryant and J. W. Milam not guilty in the torture-murder of 14-year-old African American boy Emmett Till.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar